

A CHECKLIST FROM TRAVEL GHR

The Corporate Event Travel Checklist

A practical guide to the details behind every attendee, from the first list of names to the thank-you notes afterward.

BY NICCI GROTEFENDT · TRAVEL GHR · EVERY DETAIL, QUIETLY HANDLED.

Start with the people, then the places.

A corporate event is made of individual journeys: different cities, different flights, different needs. This checklist follows the order the work usually unfolds, in eight sections. Print it, mark it up, and share the relevant pages with your team.

Each section lists what to confirm. Dates and counts will be your own, and your venue contracts and local rules always come first.

1 Attendee information

Everything else is built on this list.

- ☐ Start one master list with a row for every person: name as it appears on their ID, email, mobile, home city, and role.
- ☐ Record departure city, preferred airport, seat preference, and loyalty numbers.
- ☐ Note arrival and departure day preferences, and who needs to arrive early (hosts, speakers).
- ☐ Collect dietary and accessibility needs through one short form, so each person shares what they choose.
- ☐ Add an emergency contact for each attendee.
- ☐ Flag anyone with specific needs, such as a speaker who wants a private entrance and a quiet moment before going on.

2 Flights and ground transport

Plan for each person, then group by arrival.

- ☐ Confirm every itinerary individually, then build one arrivals grid by airport and hour.
- ☐ Match transfers to arrival clusters and allow time for baggage.
- ☐ Send written pickup details: meeting point, driver name and number, vehicle description.
- ☐ Check each day's transfer timing against the venue's loading and delivery schedule.
- ☐ Plan departure day in reverse, starting from the earliest flight.
- ☐ Decide who will meet late arrivals, and tell the hotel to expect them.

Three questions before you begin

- Who is attending, and where are they traveling from?
- What does the host of the event most want attendees to feel when they arrive?
- Who is the one person attendees can call, at any hour of the event?

3 Room blocks and the venue

Read the contract before the details feel settled.

- ☐ Read the clauses on attrition, cutoff dates, cancellation, food and beverage minimums, and service charges.
- ☐ Keep a rooming list with names, dates, bed types, and early check-in requests.
- ☐ Confirm room types for speakers and hosts.
- ☐ Ask for the floor plan or walk the space: meeting rooms, power, Wi-Fi, signage, accessible routes.
- ☐ Get the name and number of the manager on duty for each day of the event.

5 Badges and credentials

Small things people notice first.

- ☐ Spell each name the way the attendee prefers, with title and company.
- ☐ Mark speakers and hosts clearly, and print a few extra and blank badges for late additions.
- ☐ Set up a check-in table with a printed arrivals list and welcome packets.
- ☐ Arrange credentials and access for speakers, such as a private entrance or a green room.
- ☐ Place signage at entrances, elevators, and meeting rooms.

4 Meals and catering

Counts and needs travel to the kitchen in writing.

- ☐ Ask for the date final counts are due for each meal, and put it on the calendar.
- ☐ Send every dietary need from your form to the chef or banquet manager in writing.
- ☐ Ask the venue how it will prepare for each need on your list, and confirm the answer.
- ☐ For group dinners, reserve early, arrange the transport, and keep a backup venue.
- ☐ For long education days, plan refreshment breaks, water, and a place to charge devices.

6 Communicating with each attendee

One welcome note, then one personal itinerary each.

- ☐ Ask how each person likes to be reached, and match their style and tone.
- ☐ Send each person their flights, transfer, hotel, and meals in one place.
- ☐ Share a packing list built from the local weather and that person's schedule, with practical tips such as a portable battery for long days.
- ☐ Say what to wear for every evening plan, so no one has to ask.
- ☐ Send reminders at set points: ID and passport, check-in, arrival day.
- ☐ Name one person and one number to call, and answer it.

7 Onsite contingencies

Decide the second plan before you need it.

- ☐ Make a one-page contact sheet: venue manager, transport dispatcher, hotel front desk, your own number.
- ☐ Write a plan B for a delayed flight, a missed transfer, a room not ready, weather, and a change of restaurant.
- ☐ Keep a short list of people you can call for a same-day request, and keep those relationships warm all year.
- ☐ Hold a brief check-in each morning of the event.
- ☐ Tell each affected attendee about any change individually.
- ☐ Carry printed copies of key documents and a charged portable battery.

8 After the event

The follow-up is part of the event.

- ☐ Send departure reminders and confirm return transfers.
- ☐ Thank the venue, drivers, speakers, and your own team by name.
- ☐ Ask for feedback in a short form within a few days.
- ☐ Reconcile final counts and invoices against the contracts.
- ☐ Write down what to carry into next time, and update your master list.

A suggested rhythm

STAGE	FOCUS
Early	Master attendee list, venue contract review, room block, and the dietary and accessibility form.
Middle	Flights confirmed, arrivals grid, transfers, meal counts, badge names, personal itineraries.
Final stretch	Packing lists, reminders, contact sheet, plan B for each moving part.
Event week	Check-in table, morning check-ins, individual updates for any change.
After	Thank-you notes, feedback form, reconciliation, notes for next time.

Planning an event?

Nicci Grotefendt is a corporate event travel advisor and tour operator in Edwardsville, Illinois. If a conversation would help, a discovery call is a relaxed way to talk through your event: travelghr.com/contact